



What Must Come First?

Some steps depend on other steps

Name: _____

Date: _____

★ I can find the step that must come before another step.

Steps that depend on steps

In an algorithm, some steps **MUST** come before others. A step that needs another step has to come after it. Some steps can go in either order. Read the tea algorithm and answer the questions.

Make a cup of tea — the steps

A. add the milk

B. boil the water

C. put a tea bag in the cup

D. pour the water in the cup

1 What must come first?

You can only pour the water (D) once it is hot. Which step makes the water hot and must come before D? Write the letter.

2 Can it go early?

Can you add the milk (A) before you pour the water (D)? Circle YES or NO and tell why.

3 You try — order it

Two steps can be done in either order. Which two letters? Then write the whole tea algorithm in an order that works.

Big idea

When one step depends on another, it must come after it. Some steps don't depend on each other, so they can go in any order. Finding what must come first helps you plan a good algorithm.